

JBL Tour One M2

Great sound pair of headphones decked out with features

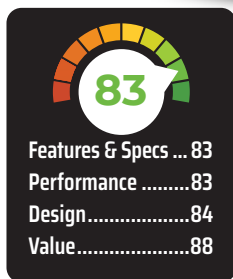
JBL has been in the audio business for some time now. The brand has its entries across budget ranges when it comes to consumer audio, especially in-ear/on-ear/over-the-ear headphones. The latest in the high-end segment of over-ear headphones was the JBL Tour One M2. The headphone showed up at the Digit Test Centre as a part of JBL's entries in the Digit Zero1 and Best Buy Awards 2023. The winner of the Digit Zero and Best Buy Award in the Best Performing Wireless Headphones Category in 2023, JBL Tour One M2, impressed us all at the Digit Test Centre. So, without further ado, let's dive into the detailed review of the JBL Tour One M2 –

BUILD AND DESIGN

The JBL Tour One M2 impress from the get go. Right from the unboxing experience to the hard carrying case included in the box, to the build of the headphones itself, there is not much to complain about. You get a fabric finish on the carrying case on the outside, with the inside covered in a suede-like, soft-touch material. The headphones sit in the case comfortably, and do not move around much. You will not have any complaints whatsoever about how safe these headphones would be inside the case.

Coming to the headphones themselves, you get a full plastic build on the cans and the headband, with the headband having a metallic inlay as a part of the adjustment mechanism. The controls are solid, and mic grills have also been colour-matched to the rest of the headphones. The branding on these headphones is also subtle and does not draw attention.

The build quality of the headphones is also solid, and leaves almost nothing to



complain about. The overall design as well is fairly muted, making these headphones suitable for use across a variety of scenarios. Whether you are out in public or in an office, you will not have much attention drawn to you, apart from the folks who are fans of gadgets that carry a minimalist aesthetic.

FEATURES

If there were one pair of headphones which I would recommend to anyone with my eyes closed, the JBL Tour One M2 would be it. You will not have much to complain about in terms of the feature set of these headphones. First off is the adaptive ANC. With the JBL Tour One M2, you get a good taste of what this technology would be like in its final form. Granted, there are a couple of scenarios where the ANC switching is not the best. However, what you get with these headphones in terms of Adaptive Noise Cancelling, is great.

The change that I could notice between walking into office and back out again into a noisy environment, and the way these headphones adapted to the noise in the office as well was something that really impressed me. As I mentioned earlier, there were a couple of scenarios where these headphones did not perform as expected. The Ambient Sound feature, which works similarly, worked wonderfully though.

This is something that JBL can possibly fix via an OTA update, so I am not that worried about it.

The JBL Tour One M2 also comes with Spatial Sound baked into the headphones, which makes the experience of listening to stereo-mastered tracks more immersive. When listening to tracks on Spotify, I did notice the difference between the experience, switching between vanilla stereo to Spatial audio. Additionally, you get Personi-fi 2.0, which is a software-level tweak that adjusts the sound of these headphones to match your physiological makeup. When I listened to tracks after completing the test, there was a noticeable difference. However, personally, I prefer the sound of these headphones out of the box. It hits the right notes for me.

For additional customisation, you also get in-app EQ on these headphones, which makes tuning the audio to your liking an even better experience than what you already have. The app also has a host of other customisation options which you can explore and make the headphones your own even more. The app is called the JBL Headphones App, and even in terms of the UI it is really appealing, un-intimidating for first-time users and easy to explore. It works well both on Android and iOS devices, so you won't have much to worry about here.

The two major gripes that I had with these headphones is their lack of the more widely accepted high-resolution CODECs like LDAC or aptX and no IP rating. JBL has added in support for LC3 and LC3+ CODECs, which I believe would be a better fit in headphones that are released later this year or early next year, when the industry has accepted them. And as for an IP rating, there are more expensive